

Playbook 1- Muhammad Zafar

Detection of LOLBAS Evasion via wuaucvt.exe and Malicious DLL Sideload

6580 - Threat Hunting

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Detection Name:

Wuaucvt Proxy Execution with Unsigned DLL Load

Threat Overview:

This detection identifies abuse of the trusted Windows binary wuaucvt.exe to execute malicious DLLs. The attacker loads a malicious DLL (e.g helpa.dll) using the /UpdateDeploymentProvider flag to evade traditional defenses, as wuaucvt.exe is a signed Microsoft binary.

Key Indicators (from Sysmon Logs):

Indicator	Value
Parent Process	wuaucvt.exe
Parent Command Line	wuaucvt.exe /UpdateDeploymentProvider C:\ProgramData\Intel\helpa.dll /RunHandlerComServer
DLL Loaded	C:\ProgramData\Intel\helpa.dll
DLL Signed	False
Spawned Process	cmd.exe
Image	SHA256=56C5AFF6AC04BDF86EDBC4F0

	D0F9581F250A4C97DD60FD1179F153AC20230920
User	LAPTOP-JU4M3I0E\bouss

Analysis Steps:

1. Correlate Process Creation:
 - a. Identity the parent (wuauc.lt.exe) and child (cmd.exe) processes.
 - b. Check for unusual command-line arguments to wuauc.lt.exe.
2. Investigate the DLL (helpa.dll):
 - a. Check the DLL's origin and signature (unsigned = red flag).
 - b. Use tools like sigcheck or PESTudio to inspect further
3. Timeline Reconstruction
 - a. Use Sysmon Event IDs:
 - i. Event ID 7: DLL load (helpa.dll)
 - ii. Event ID 1: Process creation (two instances of cmd.exe)
 - b. Reconstruct the full sequence of compromise.
4. Check Persistence/Spread
 - a. Investiage if helpa.dll was dropped by another malicious process.
 - b. Check registry keys, scheduled tasks, and startup folders for persistence indicators.
5. Hunt for Additional Behaviour:
 - a. Review cmd.exe spawn actions like file drops, network connections, further execution.

Remediation Steps:

- Isolate the affected host immediately
- Remove the malicious DLL (helpa.dll) and any other suspicious files from C:\ProgramData\.
- Terminate any suspicious running processes (cmd.exe, etc.)
- Block execution of unsigned DLLs via AppLocker or WDAC where possible.
- Review GPOs or EDR setting to detect LOLBAS-style abuses in the future.
- Reimage host if compromise is deep.

Detection Strategy (Sigma Rule Abstract):

title: Wuauc!t Unsigned DLL Proxy Execution

logsource:

category: process_creation

product: windows

detection:

selection:

ParentImage: 'C:\Windiws\System32\wuauc!t.exe'

CommandLine|contains: '/UpdateDeploymentProvider'

ImageLoaded|endswith: '.dll'

Signed: false

condition: selection

Level: high

References

<https://lolbas-project.github.io/lolbas/Binaries/Wuaucflt/>

<https://attack.mitre.org/techniques/T1218/011/>